Expressions with AVOIR

- There are a number of expressions in French which, unlike in English which often uses the verb TO BE, use the verb AVOIR. They must be learnt:

▪ avoir froid/chaud	*to be cold/hot*
▪ avoir tort/raison	*to be wrong/right*
▪ avoir faim/soif	*to be hungry/thirsty*
▪ avoir peur/honte	*to be scared/ashamed*
▪ avoir (12) ans / avoir l'air ADJ.	*to be (12), to look (upset)*
▪ avoir envie de…/avoir besoin de	*to feel like (doing)/to need*
▪ avoir sommeil/avoir mal à (la tête)	*to be sleepy, to have a sore…*
▪ avoir lieu, il y a(voir)	*to take place, there is (to be)*

REVISION: Relative pronouns *"who…which…that…"*

- These words were studied in E Lent 5 and are quickly revised here.

  - *Je connais la fille <u>QUI</u> est jolie.*
  - *Elle a mangé la pizza <u>QUE</u> je lui ai donnée.*

- The main words in French that function as RELATIVE PRONOUNS are **QUE, QUI** and **DONT**. It is **not** possible to say that "qui" = "who" and "que" = "that" etc. **You need to avoid falling into this trap**.

  - **QUI** is used when the "relative" is the SUBJECT of the verb, i.e. is doing the action
    La fille qui aime la musique, qui est là, qui s'est fait mal…
    QUE is used when the "relative" is the DIRECT OBJECT of the verb, i.e. is having the action done to it.
    La fille que j'aime, que j'ai vue, que je voudrais inviter
    DONT is used in the same way as QUE, but has a built in "**de**" that may be needed and cannot just be left at the end of the phrase
    La fille dont je parle (~~que je parle de~~), dont il rêve (~~qu'il rêve de~~)

- The three relative pronouns above link the information that follows them to the **SINGLE THING OR PERSON** that precedes the pronoun (i.e. la fille in all the above examples). Sometimes it is necessary to link the information that follows the relative pronoun to a **WHOLE IDEA, FACT or CLAUSE**. To achieve this, the same relative pronouns are used, but the word **CE** is used immediately in front of it.

  - *J'ai une radio dans ma chambre que j'aime* **(I like my ROOM)**
    J'ai une radio dans ma chambre, CE que j'aime **(I like having a radio in my room)**
    Tu as déjà lu le livre qui est ennuyeux **(the BOOK is boring)**
    Tu as déjà lu le livre, CE qui est ennuyeux **(it's a pain that you've already read…)**

REVISION: y / en

- "Y" often means "there" as in "*je vais y aller demain*".

  - "Y" is of course found in the idiom **"il y a".** This impersonal idiom **can of course be used in any tense** and these common and useful examples should be learned as they are a frequent source of difficulty. They all refer to the existence of something, "there is" and the verb **ÊTRE is never used**.

il y a	PRESENT	*there is/are*
il y avait	IMPERFECT **(a non-event)**	*there was/were (a lot of people)*
il y a eu	PERFECT **(an event)**	*there was/were (an accident)*
il y aura	FUTURE	*there will be*
il y aurait	CONDITIONAL	*there would be*
il doit y avoir	present + DEVOIR	*there must be*
il devrait y avoir	conditional + DEVOIR	*there ought to be*
il a dû y avoir	perfect + DEVOIR	*there must have been (a delay)*
il devait y avoir	imperfect + DEVOIR	*there must have been (lots to drink)*
il pourrait y avoir	conditional + POUVOIR	*there might be*

  - **"EN" is an indirect object pronoun** also, and goes in the same place as "y" and causes no agreement.

  - It frequently means **"of them"** and is also used to refer to THINGS only for verbs that involve the **preposition "de"**

  - It should be remembered that **any expression of quantity that does not specify what is being "counted"** needs to use "en" – *"combien EN veux-tu?"*